Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur

Proposal for a New Course

1. Course no.: ENG4xx (level 2 UG course)

2. Course title: Film movements in Europe and the US after World War II

3. Per-week Lectures: 3 (L), Tutorial: 0 (T), Laboratory: 0 (P), Additional hours: 0 (A)

Credits (3xL+2xT+P+A): 9 Duration of course: Full semester

4. Proposing department: HSS/English

Other departments/IDP which may be interested in the proposed course:

Other faculty members interested in teaching the proposed course:

5. Proposing instructor: Syed Feroz Hassan

6. Course description:

This course will cover the new cinemas that emerged first in Europe after World War II in Italy, France, Germany, the former Czechoslovakia, the former Yugoslavia, Germany and Poland. Since this history is closely linked to the reciprocal influence of Hollywood and European cinemas, a segment of the course will also look at the 'New Hollywood' of the 1960s and '70s. The aim is to introduce students to the emergence of arthouse cinemas as a distinct sector of film production, its socio-political context, and the key films and filmmakers that emerged from the various "new waves" from these parts of the world in the second half of the twentieth century.

The film movements will be contextualized within important changes in film industries and culture in both Europe and the US. These include the dominance and then collapse of the classical Hollywood studio system, the emergence of state support for personal filmmaking in Europe, the discourse of film authorship, the increasing importance of film festivals and film clubs, and debates about the status of film and cultural production within larger debates about free-market policies. Beyond film culture, these movements will be contextualized within concerns such as postwar recovery in Europe, the Cold War, and the effects of decolonization.

B) Contents

S. No.	**Broad Title**	**Topics**	**No. of hours**
1.	Definitions	1. Art cinema, world cinema, global cinema, film authorship	3

S. No.	Broad Title	Topics	No. of hours
		2. World cinema, world literature, world music as aesthetic and market categories 3. Examples of early postwar arthouse ‘authors’: Ingmar Bergman and Robert Bresson	
2.	Italian neorealism	1. Postclassical narrative form 2. The non-actor 3. Key figures: Roberto Rossellini, Vittorio De Sica	9
3.	The French New Wave	1. From film criticism to filmmaking 2. State support and arthouse cinemas 3. The Hollywood influence 4. Key figures: Agnès Varda, François Truffaut, Jean-Luc Godard, Claude Chabrol	9
4.	The 1960s in Western Europe	1. Postwar boom and the middle-class as subject 2. Post-neorealist Italian cinema: Federico Fellini, Michelangelo Antonioni, Pier Paolo Pasolini 3. Jean-Luc Godard and the crisis of personal cinemas	4
5.	New Hollywood in the ‘70s	1. The collapse of the classical studio economy 2. The rise of the ‘independents’	6
6.	Eastern European New Waves	1. The Polish New Wave 2. The Czech New Wave 3. The Romanian New Wave post-Cold War	9
Total			40

C) Pre-requisites, if any: None

D) Short summary for inclusion in the Courses of Study booklet

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7. Recommended books:

Textbook:

- *Making Waves: New Cinemas of the 1960s*, by Geoffrey Nowell-Smith (Bloomsbury, 2012)

- Selections from *World Cinema: Critical Approaches*, ed. John Hill and Pamela Church Gibson (OUP, 2000)

Reference Books: --

8. Any other remarks: None

Dated: 11-06-2025 Proposer:

Dated: 12-06-2025 DUGC/~~DPGC~~ Convenor: Suchitra Mathur

The course is approved / not approved.

Chairman, SUGC/~~SPGC~~

Dated: